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How bus fare stages (段) actually work

Taipei and New Taipei buses do not charge one flat fare. They charge by the number of fare "segments" (段) a trip crosses, and where those segment points fall is not published as one complete list anywhere — only two examples are ever officially named.

HOW BUS FARE STAGES (段) ACTUALLY WORK			
LEGAL BASIS 臺北市公共汽車客運業營運管理自治條例, Article 11 ^[2]	FULL FARE NT\$15 per segment ^[3]	STUDENT FARE (EASycard) NT\$12 per segment ^[3]	CONCESSIONARY FARE NT\$8 per segment ^[3]
ON-BOARD TICKET SALES None — cash or e-ticket only, no change given ^[3]			

Taipei [\[//rail/thsr/stations/taipei/\]](https://rail.thsr/stations/taipei/) and New Taipei's joint-operation buses do not charge a flat fare. They charge by 段 (段次) — fare segments — and a rider who does not know where the segment points fall on their own route has no reliable way to predict whether a trip costs one fare or two before boarding.

The rule, and its legal basis

Under 臺北市公共汽車客運業營運管理自治條例 (the Taipei City ordinance governing bus operations), Article 11 sets the underlying principle: a bus operator's fare should be uniform in principle, but a route with a longer run may instead be charged by segment or by distance^[2]. Article 9 of the same ordinance requires that the fare segment point (or buffer zone) be posted on the physical stop sign itself, alongside the terminus name, first/last bus times and headway^[2] — the segment structure is not meant to be a surprise at tap-out, at least not by design.

Taipei's Public Transport Office states the practical version of the rule plainly: 「本市聯營公車依據「臺北市公共汽車客運業營運管理自治條例」第11條規定採分段收費制，同時參採橋樑、河流等自然分界及重要轉運點（如華中橋、臺北車站等）訂定，並無長度及站數之強制要求，跨越分段點即加收1段票」^[1]. In

English: segment points are sited using natural boundaries — bridges, rivers — and major transfer hubs, with **no fixed rule for how long a segment has to be or how many stops it must cover**. Crossing a segment point (or its buffer zone) simply adds one segment's fare.

New Taipei's own city buses run on the identical mechanic. The joint Taipei/New Taipei bus portal states it for both cities in one sentence: 「雙北市區公車係依路段分段收費，搭乘2段票(含)以上路線之車輛，若跨越分段點 (或分段緩衝區)，應加收1段票」^[3].

What a segment actually costs

FARE CLASS	CASH	EASycard [/TICKETING/GUIDES/CARDS-PASSES-AND-FARES/]/E-TICKET
Full fare	NT\$15	NT\$15 ^[3]
Student	NT\$12	NT\$12 (an 8-fold/20%-off card rate) ^[3]
Concessionary (elderly, disabled/companion, eligible children)	NT\$8	NT\$8 ^[3]

That per-segment rate is confirmed twice, independently: once by the joint government fare portal, and once by the operators' own trade association, which publishes the identical NT\$15/12/8 structure on its own site^[4]. Buses do not sell tickets on board and do not give change — the fare portal is explicit that payment is cash *or* stored-value card, with no other option, and no change is made for cash overpayment^[3]. Children under 115cm ride free outright; children 115cm or taller but under 6 with an identity document also ride free; one fare-paying adult may bring up to four such children at no charge^[3].

Where the segment points actually are

Officially, not many are named at all. Taipei's Public Transport Office's own FAQ gives exactly two worked examples: 華中橋 (Huazhong Bridge) and 臺北車站 (Taipei Main Station)^[1]. No government source fetched for this page publishes a complete list of every segment point on the network — Article 9 requires each one to be posted at its own stop, but that is necessarily a stop-by-stop disclosure, not a single published index.

Chinese Wikipedia's own article on Taipei's city buses offers a longer, nine-location list of what it calls "common" segment points — Shilin [/rail/metro/stations/r16/] (士林), Dazhi [/rail/metro/stations/br14/] (大直), Taipei Bridge [/rail/metro/stations/o13/] (臺北橋), Taipei Main Station, the Zhonghua Road north/south stops, Wanhua (萬華), the wholesale produce market (果菜市場), Gongguan [/rail/metro/stations/g07/] (公館), and Songshan [/rail/metro/stations/g19/] (松山) — mostly major transfer hubs or bridgeheads at the old Taipei City/County boundary^[6]. That list is not attached to any citation on the Wikipedia page itself, and it notably does **not** include

Huazhong Bridge, which is one of only two locations the regulator names directly^[1]. Both lists are published here as what they are — one official but minimal, one fuller but unverified — rather than merged into a single confident list.

How crossing multiple segments is counted

Chinese Wikipedia's article on New Taipei's own city buses gives a worked example of the counting logic. For a corridor running through zones A, B and C, with B as the segment point: riding within one zone, or from A to B, or from B to C, is one segment; riding all the way from A to C is two segments (the single-segment fare, doubled)^[7]. On a longer corridor with two segment points, A–B–C–D–E, both B and D count as crossing points^[7]. This is an illustrative example rather than a government fare rule in itself, but it does not contradict, and directly illustrates, the primary rule already confirmed above.

How many segments does a route actually have?

There is no fixed one-to-four-segment ceiling. Counting directly over this project's own already-committed New Taipei route-service data — 562 routes with a published fare row — segment counts run from 1 to 8: 128 routes are 1-segment, 77 are 2-segment, 37 are 3-segment, 13 are 4-segment, 8 are 5-segment, 3 are 6-segment, and 3 reach 8 segments, alongside a handful of free routes^[5]. Taipei-proper's committed bus dataset has no comparable segment-count field, so its distribution remains TBC.

How this interacts with transfers and the regional pass

The bidirectional MRT–bus transfer discount — NT\$8 for an ordinary card, NT\$6 for a student card, NT\$4 for a welfare card, within a 60-minute window — applies against a segment fare the same way it applies against any bus fare^[8]. That same FAQ's own title is explicit that the discount excludes "distance-charged buses" (里程收費公車) — a separate, named fare category outside the segmented system described above; its own fare mechanics remain TBC.^[8]

The TPASS 基北北桃1200都會通 regional pass sidesteps the segment system entirely for a pass holder: its own operating notice confirms unlimited rides at unlimited distance on both Taipei's joint-operation network and New Taipei's city buses^[9]. A pass holder does not pay per segment at all — there is no separate multi-segment surcharge or cap to interact with.

Specifications

Officially named segment-point examples	Huazhong Bridge, Taipei Main Station ^[1]
New Taipei published routes, segment range (committed data)	1–8 ^[5]
MRT–bus transfer discount, ordinary card	8 NT\$ ^[8]
Transfer time window	60 min ^[8]

References

7 of 9 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

- What is the basis for determining bus fare segment points?** [https://www.pto.gov.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=6B4D38874E971F4B&sms=87415A8B9CE81B16&s=9B757C0E9D8B0EA8]

公車之分段點決定之依據為何?

PRIMARY Taipei Public Transport Office (臺北市公共運輸處) accessed 2026-08-20

The regulator's own FAQ, fetched and quoted in full. Source for the Article 11 legal basis, the natural-boundary/major-transfer-point siting criteria, and the only two segment points named officially anywhere found this run: Huazhong Bridge and Taipei Main Station.
- Taipei City Public Bus Passenger Transport Business Operation Management Self-Government Ordinance** [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL012562>]

臺北市公共汽車客運業營運管理自治條例

PRIMARY Taipei City Government (臺北市政府) accessed 2026-08-20

The city's own law database, fetched in full as a complete 14-article chapter view. Source for Article 11's exact text (same-fare-in-principle, segmented or distance-based pricing permitted on longer routes) and Article 9's stop-signage requirement, which mandates that the fare segment point or buffer zone be posted at the physical stop.
- Passenger guide, including fare information** [<https://ebus.gov.taipei/RelatedLinks/TicketInfo>]

乘客須知(含票價資訊)

PRIMARY Taipei City Government and New Taipei City Government (臺北市政府與新北市政府) accessed 2026-08-20

The joint Taipei/New Taipei bus portal's own fare page, fetched and quoted in full. Source for the NT\$15/12/8 fare tiers, the segmented-fare rule stated for both cities together (雙北), the no-on-board-sales/no-change rule, and the free-ride rules for young children.
- Fares** [<https://www.busgroup.org.tw/fare>]

票價

PRIMARY Taipei City Bus Operators' Trade Association (臺北市公共汽車客運商業同業公會) accessed 2026-08-20

The operators' own trade association's fare page, fetched in full, independently stating the same NT\$15/12/8 fare structure as the government portal — corroboration from a separate publisher, not a repeated citation.

- 5 **New Taipei bus route list** [<https://data.ntpc.gov.tw/api/datasets/0ee4e6bf-cee6-4ec8-8fe1-71f544015127/json?size=1000>]
公車路線清單
PRIMARY New Taipei City Department of Transportation (新北市府交通局) accessed 2026-08-19
The full current New Taipei route-service dataset, already fetched and committed to this project for the bus-route content work (data/ntpc/bus-route-service.json). This page's segment-count range and distribution (1 to 8 segments across 562 rows) is a direct count over that already-committed primary data, not a new claim.
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- 6 **Taipei city buses** [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/臺北市市區公車>]
臺北市市區公車
SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-20
Gives a nine-location list of 'common' segment points (Shilin, Dazhi, Taipei Bridge, Taipei Main Station, the Zhonghua Road stops, Wanhua, the wholesale produce market, Gongguan, Songshan), fetched and quoted in full. The article attaches no citation to this sentence, so it is used here as an unverified secondary lead, not confirmed fact — and it does not include Huazhong Bridge, which the PTO's own FAQ names directly.
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- 7 **New Taipei city buses** [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/新北市市區公車>]
新北市市區公車
SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-20
Gives a worked zone-crossing example (A區/B區/C區, and a longer A–E example) illustrating how crossing a segment buffer zone adds one segment fare, fetched and quoted in full. Illustrative only; the underlying rule it illustrates is separately confirmed on the primary ebus-fare-info page.
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- 8 **What is the two-way transfer discount between MRT and bus (excluding distance-charged buses)? How is it deducted for each stored-value card type?** [https://www.metro.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=566DA580861CEE77&sms=87415A8B9CE81B16&s=1CDFC00134A98701]
何謂捷運與公車（不含里程收費公車）間雙向轉乘優惠？儲值卡各票種雙向轉乘優惠如何扣款？
PRIMARY 臺北大眾捷運股份有限公司 (Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation) accessed 2026-08-12
Reused from content/ticketing/guides/cards-passes-and-fares.md, where it was originally fetched. Source for the NT\$8/NT\$6/NT\$4 transfer discount by card type, the 60-minute window, and the FAQ's own title naming 'distance-charged buses' (里程收費公車) as an explicit exclusion — a real, named exception category distinct from the segmented network this page describes.
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- 9 **基北北桃都會通 operating notice** [https://www.easycard.com.tw/_upload/files/Megacity%20Pass.pdf]
基北北桃都會通使用須知
PRIMARY
EasyCard Corporation, issued on behalf of the Keelung, Taipei, New Taipei and Taoyuan city governments
accessed 2026-08-12

Reused from content/ticketing/guides/cards-passes-and-fares.md. Source for the TPASS pass covering Taipei and New Taipei city buses at unlimited rides and unlimited distance — meaning a pass holder does not pay per-segment at all while the pass is active, with no separate interaction rule needed against the fare-stage system this page describes.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.